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Edition

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Antilia bomb threat case

PARAMBIR IN PARAM SPOT

Retired ACP triggers fresh storm, seeks probe into Parambir Singh's alleged role

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The sensational Antilia terror-scare and Mansukh Hiran murder case has been thrown open to another potentially explosive legal challenge, with a retired Assistant Commissioner of Police moving the National Investigation Agency (NIA) Special Court seeking a fresh investigation into the alleged role of former Mumbai Police Commissioner Parambir Singh (IPS). Singh did not respond to calls from this newspaper.

Retired ACP Bhimraj alias Bhimrao Rohidas Ghadge has filed an intervention application in the Special Case in 2021 arising from an NIA crime, reportedly demanding further investigation under Section 173(8) of the Code of Criminal Procedure. The application was filed on August 25, 2026, via Adv. Bhushan Bendre.

Ghadge has placed before the court a statement recorded by the NIA on August 5, 2021, of cybersecurity professional Ishaan Devesh Sinha, cited as a witness in the NIA chargesheet. Ghadge contends that the statement raises serious questions about the circumstances in which an electronic report relating to the Antilia threat was prepared and subsequently leaked.

According to the statement reproduced in the application, Sinha told investigators that he met the then Mumbai Police Commissioner Parambir Singh on March 9, 2021, and discussed the Telegram channel 'Jaish-ul-Hind', including information allegedly traced by the Delhi Police Special Cell.

Sinha allegedly told the NIA that Singh asked him to prepare a written report. The witness claimed that he prepared the report on his laptop while sitting in the Commissioner's office.

After examining the report, Singh allegedly instructed Sinha to insert the poster claiming responsibility for the Antilia terror scare. Sinha further allegedly stated that Singh told him the report was required because the Inspector General of the NIA was going to meet him.

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PRICE HIKE HITS HARD

City getting costlier as CNG, milk, autos, PNG prices go up

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For Mumbaikars, September has started with several routine expenses moving upward at once. CNG and PNG became costlier from September 1, while milk prices and auto-taxi fares have also risen, adding pressure to household and commuting budgets.

Mahanagar Gas Ltd (MGL) has increased the price of CNG by Rs. 2 per kg and domestic PNG by Rs. 1 per standard cubic metre across Mumbai and surrounding areas. CNG now costs Rs. 88 per kg, while domestic PNG is priced at Rs. 53 per SCM. MGL has cited higher gas costs and the impact of geopolitical developments in West Asia as the reason for the increase.

The increase in fuel cost comes with a rise in public transport fare. The minimum fare for an autorickshaw has moved from Rs. 26 to Rs. 27 for the first 1.5 km, while the minimum fare for black-and-yellow taxis has risen from Rs. 31 to Rs. 33. The revised fares apply across the Mumbai Metropolitan Region (MMR) from September 1.

For those who do not travel regularly, a price increase of Rs. 1 or Rs. 2 may not be significant. But for those who travel regularly, this additional expense can accumulate over weeks and months. The CNG price increase can also affect the operating costs of vehicles that depend on the fuel.

On the other hand, milk, which is another essential in all Indian households, is getting expensive too. The wholesale price of buffalo milk in Mumbai has increased by Rs. 9 per litre, from Rs. 93 to Rs. 102, effective September 1. The increase applies to the wholesale rate and should not be confused with a uniform Rs. 9 increase in the retail price of every milk brand. Rising costs of cattle feed, fodder and maintaining dairy animals have been cited among the reasons for the hike.

Cooking-related costs are also showing a mixed picture. The price of a 19-kg commercial LPG cylinder in Mumbai has increased by Rs. 9.50, from Rs. 2,691.50 to Rs. 2,701. The cylinder is primarily used by commercial establishments such as restaurants and eateries. In contrast, the 14.2-kg domestic LPG cylinder remains unchanged at Rs. 941.50.

This distinction is important because not every household expense has increased simultaneously. Vegetable prices, for instance, can move sharply depending on arrivals, weather conditions and supply and demand. A rise in the price of a particular vegetable at one market cannot automatically be treated as evidence of broad-based inflation.

Yet the simultaneous increase in several recurring expenses is significant for urban households. Transport and food are among the categories that people find difficult to avoid, meaning even relatively small increases can put pressure on monthly budgets.

For Mumbai's middle-class households, the concern is less about one isolated price hike and more about the cumulative effect. Higher commuting costs, costlier milk and increased household gas prices can leave families with less disposable income for shopping, dining out, entertainment and other discretionary spending.

The ongoing conflict in West Asia is also putting pressure on gas prices. The crisis has pushed up international gas prices, while MGL says a significant portion of the gas used for its CNG segment is sourced through imported spot regasified LNG (RLNG). As imported gas becomes more expensive, the higher input cost is being passed on partly to consumers through the latest CNG and PNG price hikes.

The September price increases raise a larger question for Mumbai: when several routine expenses become costlier together, how much more can household budgets absorb before consumers are forced to cut back?

MUMBAI'S SEPTEMBER PRICE PINCH

CNG, milk, autos, PNG and more: What's costlier from Sept 1

ITEM	EARLIER PRICE (Till Aug 31)	NEW PRICE (From Sept 1)	INCREASE	CHANGE ↑
CNG (per kg)	₹86/kg	₹88/kg	₹2/kg	↑
Domestic PNG (per SCM)	₹52/SCM	₹53/SCM	₹1/SCM	↑
Buffalo Milk (wholesale) (per litre)	₹93/litre	₹102/litre	₹9/litre	↑
Auto Minimum Fare (first 1.5 km)	₹26	₹27	₹1	↑
Black-Yellow Taxi Minimum Fare (first 1.5 km)	₹31	₹33	₹2	↑
Commercial LPG (19 kg cylinder)	₹2,691.50	₹2,701	₹9.50	↑
Domestic LPG (14.2 kg cylinder)	₹941.50	₹941.50	No change	—

Note: Milk price is wholesale buffalo-milk rate. | Source: Mahanagar Gas Ltd (MGL), Mumbai Metropolitan Region Transport Authority (MMRTA), IndianOil (IOC), Media reports



FROM THE EDITOR'S DESK

Pune Times Mirror, Mumbai
S Balakrishnan

Congress action does not portend any good

The Congress' outrage over the humiliation of its all-India president Mallikarjun Kharge by BJP persons in Haldwani, Uttarakhand, recently is not only understandable but also justified. But surely, the Congress is going overboard on the issue by burning copies of the 'Manusmriti'. The president of the Mumbai unit of the Indian Youth Congress, Zeenat Shabrin, has confirmed that she did burn a copy of the 'Manusmriti' on Monday in front of the BJP office at Dadar. What gives her the right to burn the scripture of another religion?

To be sure, there are certain parts in the 'Manusmriti' which are anti-democratic and controversial, and they need to be deleted. But then scriptures of several other religions justify slavery and speak against women. Will these also be burnt? The burning of books considered reactionary is not the solution to caste or gender issues. Such acts will not only hurt religious sentiments but also incite communal passions.

What needs to be fought is the mindset that endorses casteism, which has caused immense damage to our social fabric. And it is not a curse of only Hinduism, but of other religions as well. The law mandates that once a Dalit or tribal Hindu converts to another religion, he is deprived of benefits which accrue to scheduled castes and tribes. Yet, vested interests want the benefits to be made available even after conversion. If this is permitted, it will open the floodgates of religious conversions. The cold reality is that religious conversion does not change the social status of the converted. He continues to labour under the weight of social discrimination.

It's high time we, as a nation, make a frontal attack on casteism, which is a sure way of ushering in real democracy. Dalits like Kharge then will not have to face any humiliation.

Hair reportedly found twice in food

Customer alleges unhygienic kitchen conditions

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A food hygiene complaint concerning a hotel in Nalasopara has surfaced on social media after a customer alleged that hair was found in his food twice despite the dish being replaced.

According to a post shared on X, the incident allegedly took place at New Sagar Hotel in Nalasopara. The post identifies Mohammad Sajid as the person running the establishment.

The customer claimed that he initially found hair in the food served to him at the hotel. After the complaint was raised, the plate was reportedly replaced. However, according to the same account, hair was allegedly found in the replacement plate as well.

The customer further claimed that the hotel owner told him not to pay for the food and asked him not to create a ruckus over the matter.

The complaint did not end at the dining area. According to the account shared on X, the customer subsequently entered the hotel's kitchen and alleged that several unhygienic practices were visible there.

The customer alleged that there was no separate arrangement for handling vegetarian and non-vegetarian food. He also claimed that rotten onions were present in the kitchen. The post further alleges that workers were eating inside the kitchen area and that gutka was being consumed and spat there.

Another allegation concerns the handling of chicken. According to the customer's account, chicken was being cleaned in the same area where other kitchen activities were taking place.

The claims have raised questions over food handling and hygiene practices at the establishment. However, the allegations circulating on social media have 'not been independently verified by this newspaper'.

The customer also claimed that authorities were alerted about the alleged conditions. According to the post, the response received was that officials would visit the establishment after two days. At present, there is no publicly available inspection report or official statement confirming the allegations made in the social media post.

The incident comes amid continued concerns over hygiene and food safety at eateries, where improper food handling and inadequate kitchen sanitation can pose risks to consumers.

Residents to follow Dalvi Pattern

Vow to transform Tilak Nagar in two years

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A new people-driven movement for cleanliness and sustainable solid waste management is taking shape in Tilak Nagar, Chembur, with around 300 housing society office-bearers resolving to work collectively towards transforming the area into a clean, beautiful, healthy and model residential neighbourhood within the next two years through the implementation of the 'Dalvi Pattern'. "Cleanliness is not merely the responsibility of the municipal corporation. It is a way of life for every citizen and a collective responsibility of every housing society. If citizens begin with themselves, meaningful transformation is certainly possible," said Dr. Subhash Dalvi, an expert in solid waste management, while addressing a special guidance workshop organised by the Tilak Nagar Residents Welfare Association recently.

Dr. Dalvi, Founder and Director of Asthashree Sustainability Foundation, provided detailed guidance to office-bearers of nearly 300 cooperative housing societies on source-level waste segregation, composting, scientific solid waste management, civic discipline, environmental sustainability and citizen participation.



He also emphasised the importance of coordinated participation by the municipal corporation, Mumbai Police, elected representatives, housing societies and citizens in creating a sustainable cleanliness ecosystem. Explaining the philosophy behind the Dalvi Pattern,

Dr. Dalvi said waste should not be treated merely as something to be discarded.

If waste is segregated at source, wet waste can be processed into compost while dry waste can be appropriately channelled for recycling and recovery. This can enable individual housing societies to establish effective waste management systems within their own premises.

"Waste must be managed where it is generated. Segregation at home, processing within the society and citizen participation are the keys to sustainable cleanliness," Dr. Dalvi said.

The concept seeks to take cleanliness beyond short-term campaigns and make it a permanent part of citizens' daily lives, behaviour and social values.

Dr. Dalvi expressed confidence that a coordinated effort by the housing societies of Tilak Nagar could transform the locality into a model residential area within two years.

The programme was presided over by local MLA Mangesh Kudalkar, who assured his full support to the initiative and stated that he would personally participate in the cleanliness drive.

Prakash Darekar, President of Mumbai District Housing Federation, reaffirmed the federation's commitment to addressing the concerns of cooperative housing societies.

Local corporator Susham Sawant assured that efforts would be made to strengthen citizen participation and facilitate the required administrative support for making Tilak Nagar clean and beautiful.

WOMAN DIES IN MALAD MISHAP

Electric car hits scooter at traffic signal

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A 34-year-old woman was killed and her husband was seriously injured after an electric MG Windsor allegedly rammed into their scooter at Mamledar Wadi Junction in Malad West on Sunday evening. The couple was waiting at a traffic signal when the car suddenly moved forward and hit their Activa, according to the reports.

The deceased, Priyanka Satra, was an advocate, while her husband Mayank Satra runs an imitation jewellery business. The couple, who lived in Malad, have two children, an eight-year-old daughter and a four-year-old son.

The accident took place at around 8 pm on August 30. Mayank and Priyanka were reportedly waiting for the traffic signal to turn green when the MG Windsor allegedly surged forward and crashed into their scooter. The car then went on to hit three autorickshaws, according to the report. Several passengers and drivers were injured in the crash.

Priyanka suffered critical injuries and later died. Mayank sustained serious injuries and was admitted to hospital for treatment. The sudden accident has left the family facing the loss of a mother while her husband is still recovering from his injuries.

The aftermath of the accident was particularly difficult for the family. On Monday, Mayank was brought home from hospital in a wheelchair so that he could see his wife one last time before her funeral. Relatives and friends gathered as Priyanka's funeral procession left for the crematorium.

The police registered a case following a complaint by Mayank's brother, Manthan Devji Satra. The case was registered under Sections 106(1), 281 and 125(A)(B) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and Section 184 of the Motor Vehicles Act. The accused driver was medically examined and arrested, according to the report.

The accused was later produced before the Borivli Metropolitan Magistrate's Court and sent to judicial custody. A bail application was subsequently filed, and he was released on a Rs 15,000 bond.

The police said the driver allegedly pressed the accelerator instead of the brake and drove rashly and negligently. The vehicle subsequently hit the scooter and three autorickshaws. People at the spot alerted the police and handed the driver over to the authorities.

The crash has also renewed concerns about road safety, particularly regarding elderly motorists and their ability to react quickly in sudden situations. An activist quoted in the report called for regular fitness and driving assessments for elderly drivers.



MSEDCL cracks down on electricity theft

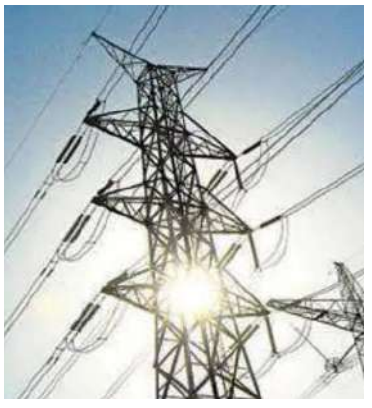
Uncovers pilferage worth ₹76 lakh in 22 cases

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Maharashtra State Electricity Distribution Company Limited (MSEDCL) has launched a special drive to curb electricity theft under its Bhandup Circle. As part of the campaign, 22 cases of power theft were detected in the CBD Belapur Sub-Division during August, involving the theft of 190,757 units of electricity valued at Rs 76.85 lakh.

According to MSEDCL, two cases detected in Ulwe involved electricity theft worth Rs 51.41 lakh and

Rs 11.84 lakh, respectively. The amounts were subsequently recovered from the concerned consumers. The action was carried out under the guidance of Vashi Division Superintending Engineer Deepak Patil and under the supervision of Nerul Division Executive Engineer Suhas Bedagkar and CBD Sub-Division Additional Executive Engineer Prashant Banait. The cases were registered under



Section 135 of the Electricity Act, 2003. During the inspections, several irregularities were detected, including tampering with meters, bypassing meters and illegally drawing electricity through service wires.

Chief Engineer Sanjay Patil urged consumers to use electricity honestly and responsibly. He warned that consumers found stealing electricity would face criminal proceedings if they failed to pay the applicable bills and penalties within the stipulated period. MSEDCL said the special drive against electricity theft would continue.

Notice to Cong workers

They protested over 'anti-Dalit mindset' of BJP

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A day after the Mumbai Pradesh Youth Congress staged a protest outside the BJP office in Dadar over what it called the party's "anti-Dalit mindset", Congress workers have been issued notices by the Bhoiwada police in connection with the demonstration.

The protest was held on August 31, with Youth Congress workers burning copies of the 'Manusmriti' and raising slogans against what they described as caste discrimination and the humiliation of Dalits. The demonstration was led by Zeenat Shabrin, president of the Mumbai Pradesh Youth Congress.

The protest was organised in response to the controversy over the alleged "purification" of a venue after a rally addressed by Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge in Haldwani. The Youth Congress alleged that such an act reflected a casteist and "Manuvadi" mindset and said it was an insult not only to Kharge but also to Dalits and the values of the Constitution.



Zeenat Shabrin, president, Mumbai Pradesh Youth Congress

A large number of office-bearers and workers from the Mumbai Pradesh Youth Congress, including representatives from the state, district and assembly-level units, participated in the demonstration outside the BJP office.

Speaking to PTM Mumbai, Shabrin said three of her colleagues were taken into police custody during the protest. According to her, they were released on the afternoon of September 1. She also claimed that one of the workers was taken into custody from his home.

The police action has now continued with notices issued to Congress leaders and workers. A notice issued by the Bhoiwada police station on September 1 under Section 35(3) of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita asks the concerned persons to remain available for the investigation.

The notice lays down several conditions, including appearing before the investigating officer when required, cooperating with the investigation, providing relevant information and documents, and not attempting to influence witnesses or interfere with the investigation. It also warns that failure to comply with the directions could lead to further legal action as permitted under law.

The police notice is linked to the investigation into the protest, with the document referring to provisions of law in connection with the case.

For the Youth Congress, however, the protest was primarily a political response to what it considers an attack on the dignity of Dalits. The organisation has maintained that burning the 'Manusmriti' was a symbolic act against caste-based discrimination.

The latest police notices come as the political dispute continues beyond the protest itself. While the Congress has accused the BJP and RSS of promoting a casteist mindset, the allegations remain part of the political contest between the two sides.

The police investigation will now determine the role of those named in the case and whether further action is required.

Questions raised over disposal of debris

Sajag Nagrik Manch files complaint with PMO

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Navi Mumbai, which is recognised as the third cleanest city in the country, is now facing questions over the official disposal system for construction and demolition debris within the jurisdiction of the Navi Mumbai Municipal Corporation (NMMC).

Sajag Nagrik Manch has filed a complaint with the Prime Minister's Office (PMO), seeking an independent inquiry and appropriate action. According to the forum, it had sought information through the Right to Information (RTI) Act from CIDCO and the Navi Mumbai Municipal Corporation regarding authorised debris collection centres, disposal and recycling facilities, transportation arrangements, and action taken against those illegally dumping debris. The forum claims that responses to several key queries stated that the "information is not available".

The citizens' forum said that redevelopment, road works, metro construction and other infrastructure projects are generating large quantities of construction and demolition debris across Navi Mumbai. In such circumstances, it argued, merely taking action against those who illegally dump debris is not sufficient. A legal, accessible and transparent disposal system for citizens and contractors is equally essential.

The forum has expressed concern that, due to the lack of adequate authorised disposal facilities, debris is allegedly being secretly dumped near mangroves, wetlands, natural drains, water bodies and creek banks. Such dumping could pose a serious threat to drainage systems, biodiversity and the environment, it said.

The forum has called for an integrated waste-management policy, adequate disposal facilities, modern recycling plants, a 'Debris on Call' service, digital passes and GPS tracking. It has also demanded that major development projects be required to prepare and implement a comprehensive debris-management plan. Dattaram Sakpal of Sajag Nagrik Manch said that, as Navi Mumbai is recognised as the thirdcleanest city in the country, it should also have a world-class and scientific system for handling the waste generated by development activities.

2 cr names cut from draft voter list

Mass deletions trigger fierce backlash from opposition and activists

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Following the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) drive across all 288 assembly constituencies in Maharashtra, the draft electoral rolls have officially been published. A staggering total of 2,06,88,487 voters amounting to 21.14% of the state's electorate have been removed compared to the pre-SIR voter rolls.

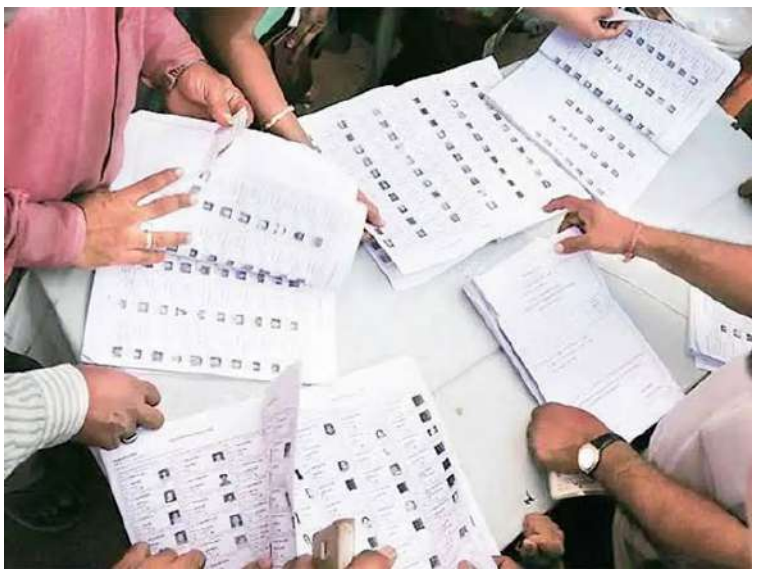
This massive deletion has sparked a major political controversy, drawing sharp criticism from opposition leaders and prominent social activists.

Pune, Thane, and Mumbai Suburban hit hardest

Pune district saw the highest number of exclusions, with 28,66,481 voter enumeration forms missing or uncollected. It is followed by Thane (28,59,377), Mumbai Suburban (26,58,202), and Nagpur (14,43,267). Deletions also reached 10.27 lakh in Nashik, 9.50 lakh in Mumbai City, 6.68 lakh in Palghar, and 6.22 lakh in Solapur. Remarkably, over 83.84 lakh uncollected enumeration forms originated from Pune, Thane, and Mumbai Suburban alone.

Widespread backlash and political outrage

The scale of the deletions has drawn swift condemnation from across the political and social spectrum. Congress leader Rahul Gandhi slammed the move, pointing out that nearly one in every five voters in Maharashtra has been removed, which he alleged is a deliberate tactic by the BJP and the Election Commission to secure electoral victory and undermine democracy.



Echoing these concerns, NCP (SP) leader Rohit Pawar labelled the deletion drive a targeted 'national campaign' to eliminate opposition voters while retaining BJP supporters, suggesting the SIR drive be renamed 'Special BJP Voter Confirmation' (SBVC).

Congress leader Satej Patil demanded immediate transparency, calling on the Election Commission of India (ECI) to release machine-readable comparative voter data from 2024, conduct independent multi-party audits of all deleted names, and set up special enrolment camps through September 30.

Social activist Anjali Damania also voiced strong outrage, characterising the exclusion of over two crore citizens particularly working class communities and migrants in urban centres like Pune and Thane as a severe blow to democratic integrity.

She emphasised that disenfranchising voters due to missed paperwork or administrative technicalities represents a travesty of justice, asserting that voting is a non-negotiable constitutional right rather than a privilege.

DRAFT ELECTORAL ROLL BREAKDOWN

- Pre-SIR Total Voters: 9,78,54,049
- Total Voters in Draft Roll: 7,71,65,562
- Male Voters: 3,95,89,905
- Female Voters: 3,75,72,570
- Third Gender Voters: 3,087

Auto driver killed, 2 held

Victim was attacked with sharp weapon near Mini Seashore

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An autorickshaw driver lost his life at the Mini Seashore in Vashi, Navi Mumbai, following a petty dispute over a fare difference of just Rs. 50. The Navi Mumbai Crime Branch and Vashi police have cracked the case and arrested two suspects in Mankhurd.

The deceased has been identified as Sujankumar Feku Mahato (18), a resident of Ghansoli.

According to the police, at around 3.30 a.m. on August 29, two youths boarded Sujan's autorickshaw from Koparkhairane railway station, intending to travel to Mankhurd. A dispute arose when the suspects offered to pay only Rs. 100 after being told the fare was Rs. 150.

Reportedly, the argument soon took a serious turn. The accused brandished a sharp weapon and forced Sujan to walk. Later, in the Mini Seashore area near Fortis Hospital in Vashi, Sujan asked them to get out of the auto. An altercation ensued, and the accused attacked him on his neck, head, and hands with a sharp weapon. Critically injured, Sujan died, and the accused fled in the autorickshaw.

CCTV helps solve case

Following the incident, the Crime Branch and Vashi police examined CCTV footage of the scene and the potential route taken by the accused. Based on technical investigation and received intelligence, the police arrested Sahil Anand Surve (20) and Sahil Yashwant Kharal (20) from Mankhurd.

According to the police, both confessed to the murder during questioning. The investigation revealed that the accused, Sahil Surve, had a serious case previously registered against him at the Trombay police station and had been released on bail in October 2025. This has created an atmosphere of fear among citizens, as the accused continued to commit serious crimes even after being released on bail.



Police personnel with the accused

HC wants Aadhaar law amended

To track, deport illegal foreign nationals

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A worrying loophole in India's identity and immigration system has come under the scanner of the Bombay High Court, which has asked the Centre and the Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI) to consider amending the Aadhaar law to enable agencies to trace and deport foreign nationals allegedly living illegally in India after obtaining fraudulent Indian identity documents.

A Division Bench of Justice Ajay Gadkari and Justice Kamal Khata took note of what it described as a 'concerning pattern' of foreign nationals allegedly entering India illegally, securing basic Indian documents such as Aadhaar and PAN cards through fraudulent means and subsequently using them to conceal their true identity. The court flagged what it termed a 'critical gap' in inter-agency coordination and document-verification procedures, and called for a mechanism that would enable authorities to act more swiftly against persons found to be illegally residing in the country.



The bench observed that it had come across several cases in which foreign nationals allegedly obtained basic documents after entering India illegally and subsequently procured Aadhaar cards to project an Indian identity.

The court's concern was not merely about the possession of fraudulent documents, but the difficulty faced by investigating agencies in establishing the real identity and immigration status of such persons once multiple Indian documents have been created in their names.

The bench therefore directed the Union Government and UIDAI to consider whether amendments to the Aadhaar (Targeted Delivery of Financial and Other Subsidies, Benefits and Services) Act, 2016 were necessary to address the problem.

The High Court said the existing legal framework should be examined so that agencies investigating illegal immigration and identity fraud can obtain necessary information through a legally regulated process.

The objective, according to the court, is to ensure that persons found to be illegally residing in India can be identified, traced and proceeded against for deportation without unnecessary procedural delays.

Aadhaar does not decide citizenship

The proceedings also reinforce an important legal distinction: an Aadhaar card is an identity document and, by itself, is not proof of Indian citizenship. The High Court's intervention seeks to address the alleged misuse of identity infrastructure while ensuring that any disclosure or investigation takes place within the statutory framework.

Parambir in param spot

CONTINUED FROM PAGE 1

The witness statement also contains an allegation concerning a Rs. 5 lakh cash payment. Sinha allegedly told investigators that Singh initially instructed his personal assistant to pay him Rs. 3 lakh, but subsequently called the assistant back and directed that the payment be increased to Rs. 5 lakh. Sinha claimed he received the amount in cash in Singh's presence in the latter's office.

The retired ACP's application highlights another crucial portion of the witness statement. Sinha allegedly told the NIA that the original report prepared by him was short and did not contain the Antilia threat poster. According to the statement, the version later shown to him had been modified pursuant to directions allegedly given by Singh.

Sinha also reportedly told investigators that he was shocked to see details of the report published in newspapers the following day, despite having informed the Commissioner that the information was confidential and that the Delhi Police Special Cell was still working on it. Ghadge has questioned why Singh was not investigated or made an accused despite the contents of the witness statement.

In a representation dated July 4, 2026, addressed to the NIA's Mumbai unit, Ghadge had specifically sought that Singh's name be investigated and, if warranted, added as an accused. He claims copies were also sent to the NIA Director General and Maharashtra DGP, but he received no response.

The application alleges that the NIA failed to conduct further investigation despite having the power to do so under Section 173(8) CrPC.

Ghadge has also sought examination of call detail records and communications allegedly involving Singh, Sachin Waze and other accused to establish whether there were links relevant to the alleged conspiracy.

The application notes that charges were framed against all ten accused on August 1, 2026, making the plea for further investigation particularly significant. Ghadge has sought permission to intervene in the trial and make submissions, besides requesting a direction for further investigation into the alleged roles of Singh and Witness number 152.

Anna Hazare hospitalised in Mumbai
— Social activist Anna Hazare has been hospitalised at Bombay Hospital after his health deteriorated. He is reportedly suffering from a kidney infection. Last week, Hazare was admitted to Vedant Hospital in Shirur after experiencing urinary problems.

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Wednesday, September 2, 2026
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FDA busts stale snacks racket

Expiry dates were being wiped out and fresh dates were being stamped in Navi Mumbai

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In a shocking discovery that should send chills down every consumer's spine, the Food and Drug Administration and Navi Mumbai Crime Branch have busted a massive racket that was quietly wiping out expiry dates on packaged snacks and stamping fresh, fake ones in their place, potentially pushing stale, unsafe food straight into your shopping bag.

What officials found there has exposed a brazen operation designed purely to cheat consumers and dodge food safety laws. The modus operandi was as simple as it was dangerous. Officials say the original manufacturing and expiry dates on packaged food were being erased and replaced with new, doctored dates. On top of that, fresh stickers were being slapped over original ingredients and nutritional information, before the entire tampered stock was repackaged and sent back into the market as if nothing had happened.

The scale of the seizure is staggering. Authorities confiscated 4,942 cartons of packaged food linked to 10 nominated exporter companies, worth a jaw dropping Rs 75,21,269. An additional stash worth roughly Rs 30,600, comprising unlabelled and expired food, was also seized on the spot.

And the list of brands caught up in this mess reads like a shopping cart from every Indian household. Lay's Classic Salted, Magic Masala, Spanish Tangy Tomato, Sizzling Hot, Lemon Chilli, Aloo and Hot & Sweet. Kurkure's entire range including Masala Munch, Red Chilli Chataka, Naughty Tomato, Solid Masti and Puffcorn Yummy Cheese. Bingo Mad Angles Achaari, Fun Flips in multiple flavours, Maggi Masala and Atta Noodles, Rasoi's ready to eat Amritsari Paneer Tikka Masala, Dum Aloo, Paneer Bhurji and Dal Makhni, Knorr Mushroom Soup, Hellmann's Mayonnaise, and even canned Thums Up and Limca.

Ten exporter firms have been named in connection with the racket, spread across Noida, Mulund, Ghatkopar, Malad, Fort, Andheri, Chembur and even Delhi. As if that wasn't damning enough, three more entities, M/s Unique Fragrances, M/s Pristine Worldwide and M/s Vipul Doshi, were found operating without valid FSSAI licences or purchase bills, and their samples have now been taken for further scrutiny.

An FIR, numbered 457/2026, has been registered at Turbhe police station invoking multiple sections of the Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006, and the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023. The food licence of M/s Sadhna Enterprises has been suspended with immediate effect. FDA Commissioner Tukaram Munde did not mince words while announcing the crackdown.

"Maharashtra is extremely strict about the quality of food products and enforcement of the law. The health of consumers and the public will not be compromised under any circumstances. This kind of strict legal action will continue against anyone selling or stocking expired or tampered food products," he warned.

The operation was carried out under the guidance of Joint Commissioner Sachin Jadhav and Assistant Commissioner Ajit Maitre, with a team of FDA officers, alongside DCP Sachin Gunjal and ACP Bhausaheb Dhole of Navi Mumbai Crime Branch.

CM targets UPA govt

'Selective coverage of historical figures in textbooks'

#MUMBAI
@ThePuneMirror



Chief Minister **Devendra Fadnavis (in pic)** has targeted the previous UPA government over the NCERT historical curriculum, alleging selective coverage of historical figures in school textbooks during its tenure.

Addressing the BJP Maharashtra State Executive Meeting, Fadnavis claimed that NCERT textbooks during the UPA rule dedicated 13 pages to the Mughals while it allegedly reduced the history of Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj to a single passage.

Drawing a contrast with the current administration's approach to national icons, Fadnavis stated that under Prime Minister Narendra Modi's leadership, the updated curriculum has allocated 17 pages to Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj.

Taking a further swipe at the opposition, the chief minister also accused the Congress of targeting the Ram Mandir donation controversy, alleging that the party attempted to misrepresent the issue by framing it as a case of looting.

"During the UPA era, NCERT textbooks had 13 pages for the Mughals and one passage for Shivaji. During PM Modi's time the curriculum gave 17 pages to Shivaji. Initially they opposed on issues, then they targeted the Ram temple case. They tried to set a narrative that the Ram temple was looted. Their next target is the Kumbh Mela. Come and see: Kumbh tenders were awarded at 20% lower prices..." said Fadnavis.

In a post on social media platform X, Fadnavis launched a frontal attack on Congress, accusing the opposition party of allegedly opposing the construction of the Ram Mandir and attempting to spread misleading narratives regarding the upcoming Trimbakeshwar MahaSimhastha Kumbh Mela 2027.

Widening his attack, Fadnavis targeted the Congress over the Women's Reservation Bill, accusing the party of allegedly stalling and killing the legislation during its tenure. He drew a parallel with the current administration's track record, emphasising that Prime Minister Narendra Modi has taken significant measures to empower women and youth through key initiatives such as 'Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao' and 'Lakhpati Didi' to create greater opportunities for their progress.

Outlining the state's economic and developmental roadmap, the Chief Minister reaffirmed the government's resolve to achieve a $1-trillion economy for Maharashtra by 2030, while contributing toward the broader vision of a 'Viksit Maharashtra' and a 'Viksit Bharat' by 2047. **ANI**

Bappa ready for foreign shores

The trend for idols in 'Dhotar-Pheta' and diamond work sees high demand

Pramod Patil
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@ThePuneMirror



Pen, known as the home of Ganesh idols, is witnessing significant demand for its exquisite and beautiful Ganesha idols again this year. Sculptors have reported that 90 per cent of the demand is for eco-friendly idols made from 'Shadu' (clay). Pen's idols are exported not just across India, but also to countries including the USA, Bangkok, and Thailand, with shipments beginning as early as February and March. There is a substantial demand for these exports again this year. With less than 20 days remaining until the Ganeshotsav festival, there is a buzz of activity in the factories.

This year, alongside traditional idols such as the Titwala Ganesha, Dagdusheth Halwai, and Lalbaugcha Raja, there is a strong preference for idols adorned in traditional dhotar (dhoti) and pheta (turban), as well as those featuring intricate diamond jewellery work. While sculptors create new designs using fresh moulds every year and traditional favourites like Lalbaugcha Raja and Siddhivinayak remain in constant demand, there is a noticeable shift towards devotees purchasing uniquely styled idols this year.

Significantly, the purchases indicate a strong inclination among devotees towards celebrating an eco-friendly Ganeshotsav. Factory owners report that over 90 per cent of the idols purchased are made from eco-friendly Shadu clay, suggesting that this year's festival will be celebrated with grandeur and enthusiasm, whilst being environmentally conscious.

Significantly, the purchases indicate a strong inclination among devotees towards celebrating an eco-friendly Ganeshotsav

> "With less than 20 days remaining, we are focusing on completing as many idols as possible. Interestingly, bookings for next year's idols have already begun
> **— Sculptor Sonali Pawar,** sculptor

Sculptor Sonali Pawar notes that thousands of Ganesh idols wearing pheta and dhotar with diamond work have already been sent abroad, and demand continues. "With less than 20 days remaining, we are focusing on completing as many idols as possible. Interestingly, bookings for next year's idols have already begun," she says.

She further highlights the social impact, noting that 20 to 25 women work in their factory throughout the year, providing them with stable, year-round employment. "This is a great opportunity for them, as they have found steady work and financial independence. In fact, in these idol factories, women are now moving ahead of men in terms of participation."

The work on idols for the following year begins immediately after Ganesh Chaturthi and continues throughout the year. There is also good demand for goddess idols for the upcoming Navratri festival. Sonali Pawar expresses satisfaction that this year-round business is providing meaningful and consistent employment opportunities for women.



PROTECT SEAFARERS: MODI

Ensure freedom of navigation, commerce: PM to Iran President

#WASHINGTON
@ThePuneMirror

Prime Minister Narendra Modi held bilateral talks with Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian on Monday on the sidelines of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) Summit in Bishkek and urged the protection of commercial shipping and insisting that seafarers and civilians must not be harmed amid the ongoing West Asia conflict.

Following the meeting, the Ministry of External Affairs spokesperson stated that the two leaders discussed bilateral ties, trade, the prevailing situation in West Asia and the safety of seafarers

"The two leaders discussed various aspects of bilateral ties. They reviewed recent developments in the West Asia region. Prime Minister reiterated India's consistent position that all issues must be resolved through dialogue and diplomacy. Prime Minister also underlined the need for continued efforts to ensure peace and stability in the region and for safeguarding freedom of navigation and commerce," MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said in a statement.



Prime Minister Narendra Modi holds a bilateral meeting with Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian on the sidelines of the SCO Summit, in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan, on Monday ANI

Reiterating India's readiness to closely cooperate with Iran in multilateral organisations, including BRICS and SCO, Prime Minister Modi conveyed to Pezeshkian that he looked forward to welcoming the Iranian President to India for the BRICS Summit scheduled in New Delhi on September 12-13.

Prime Minister Modi also expressed New Delhi's resolve to "expand and diversify" bilateral trade channels with Iran, emphasising the country's dedication to deepening historic ties across multiple domains.

Sharing details of the engagement on social media, PM Modi posted, "Met President Masoud Pezeshkian in Bishkek. Reiterated our commitment to strengthening India's long-standing friendship with Iran across diverse sectors."

"We want to expand and diversify our trade basket in the times to come. We had a discussion on the prevailing situation in the region. India will continue to support all efforts aimed at ensuring lasting peace," he added.

Ministry of External Affairs spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal noted that the two leaders conducted a "fruitful meeting" focused on bilateral cooperation and a review of geopolitical dynamics across West Asia.

"Prime Minister reiterated India's consistent position that all issues must be resolved through dialogue and diplomacy," Jaiswal shared online, adding that the Prime Minister stressed the necessity of sustained initiatives to promote regional stability, security, and the protection of maritime commerce.

The high-level discussions took place against the backdrop of ongoing conflicts in West Asia impacting regional stability, commercial navigation and maritime logistics.

Iranian Foreign Minister Seyed Abbas Araghchi, along other senior delegates from Tehran, were among those who attended the bilateral meeting between the Indian Prime Minister and Iranian President.

PM Modi is on an official visit to Kyrgyzstan to attend the 26th SCO Summit and the opening ceremony of the 6th World Nomad Games.

AGENCIES

Trump goes ballistic

Reiterates claims of Iran's military destruction

#WASHINGTON
@ThePuneMirror

US President **Donald Trump (in pic)** on Monday yet again reiterated the claims of military annihilation of Iran, while also asserting that oil continues to flow out of the Strait of Hormuz with the "Navy's assistance", due to which prices have not shot up.

He made the remarks while speaking to the media from the Oval Office.

When asked about Iran, the US President said, "They're a failed nation. Yeah, they're a failed nation. They've got 350 per cent inflation. They have no currency. They're not paying their soldiers. Their leaders are largely dead. Their Navy is gone. Their Air Force is gone. Their surveillance equipment is almost entirely gone. That doesn't mean we won't smack them. See what happens."

On the situation in the Strait of Hormuz and the role being played by US Navy, Trump told the reporters, "We have the Strait of Hormuz in extremely good shape. You know, we're taking over many, many ships that got through last night, as you know, with the Navy's assistance. And we've been averaging 30 ships a night. That's a lot. And a lot of oil is coming out. That's why you haven't seen the price of oil go like they thought it might have to go."

He reiterated the stance of Washington to never allow Tehran to acquire nukes, claiming that if Iran had nuclear weapons, Israel and West



Asia would have been "wiped out".

Trump said, "Iran will never have a nuclear weapon. See, that's what it's all about. It's not about any of the other things. It's about us as a country and as for the world, Iran cannot have a nuclear weapon. If Iran had a nuclear weapon, Israel would have been wiped out. You would have no Israel right now and probably no Middle East. And they'd be hitting our cities at some point because they're sick people. And Iran will never have a nuclear weapon."

Following the US strike, Iran claimed to have launched ballistic missiles at two US air bases in Jordan, Press TV reported.

On the other hand, the Iranian Army claimed that it carried out drone strikes targeting helicopter and troop positions at the Al Minhad airbase in the UAE. **AGENCIES**

Tehran open to talks

US should return to its commitments: Pezeshkian

#BISHKEK
@ThePuneMirror

Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian on Tuesday said that Iran would "immediately reciprocate" if the United States returned to its commitments under the 14-point Memorandum of Understanding (MoU), according to the official website of the President of Iran.

Addressing the 26th Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) Summit in Bishkek, Pezeshkian said that Iran had a "brilliant record" of fulfilling its international obligations and treaties, while warning that unilateral policies, military force, illegal sanctions and geopolitical competition were threatening regional and global stability.

"The attacks carried out by the United States and the Zionist regime (Israel) against Iran on June 13, 2025 and February 28, 2026 were a clear violation of the fundamental principles of the United Nations Charter and international law, against the principle of prohibition of the use of force, and against the right to life," he said.

Pezeshkian said recent developments in West Asia, including in Iran, Lebanon, Gaza and the West Bank, had shown that disregard for international law and approaches based on force and pressure threatened the security of countries as well as regional and global stability. He said the strikes on Iran resulted in large-scale



FILE PHOTO

casualties, including strikes on a school in Minab and a stadium in Lamerd, Fars Province.

"These were just three examples of the great crimes of the first day of a 40-day war. In the face of this volume of brutality, the Islamic Republic of Iran, relying on the great power of its brave and zealous armed forces and enjoying the nationwide support of its noble nation, inflicted heavy and strategic defeats on the United States and the occupying regime and achieved brilliant victories," he said.

Pezeshkian said the strikes were an assault on an SCO member state and an "ancient civilisation", while expressing appreciation to the organisation and countries that condemned the aggression and expressed sympathy with Iran.

He said that following 40 days of "resistance" by the Iranian people and, according to Pezeshkian's claim that the US "failed" to achieve its "predetermined goals", a ceasefire and an end to the conflict were forced.

Pezeshkian said nearly three months of negotiations mediated by Pakistan and Qatar subsequently led to the 14-point MoU. **AGENCIES**

HEALTH TIP: Walnuts are widely considered the best dry fruit for heart health because they are packed with plant-based omega-3 fatty acids that reduce inflammation and protect your blood vessels.



Eating 4 to 7 walnuts daily is advised, but overconsumption can lead to digestive distress

Pune Times Mirror | 7
Wednesday, September 2, 2026
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ASK THE SEXPERT



DR ROHAN JAHAGIRDAR
Psychiatrist & Sexpert

1 I'm a 20-year-old male. I find most condoms are yellow in color. Is it made in this specific color so one is constantly aware about being cautious while having sex?
Dear Sir, No that is Not the reason. I think you are over thinking and reading too much into the colours. Because by that logic if you buy a red colour condom you should not be having sex! Hope you find the answer COLOURFUL! (pun intended)

2 I'm a 42-year-old woman.I've read that Japanese green tea is very good for health as it enhances one's sexual performance. Is that true?
Ma'am, Yes it is associated with boosting immunity, also reducing fatigue and in certain cases it is also considered as a natural aphrodisiac. However, it can aid in maintaining an overall healthy lifestyle but not as a treatment for medical or sexual conditions.

3 I'm a 27-year-old girl. I went for a foot massage on my Holiday and felt I was getting turned on. Can feet be a pleasurable point?
Ma'am, the feet have many nerve endings and the idea of being touched could have led to you having sensual thoughts. It can normally happen and for this very reason couples indulge in touching different body parts as a part of foreplay.

4 I'm a 48-year-old woman. Can menopause make my sexual intercourse painful?
Dear Ma'am, the menopause can lead to vaginal dryness which is one of the commonest reasons for the painful intercourse. You can try using a vaginal moisturizer or a lubricant but do see a doctor to address the overall symptoms of your menopause.

SEND YOUR QUERIES RELATED TO SEXUAL PROBLEMS TO
sexpert@punemirror.com



IT'S NOT ONE-SIZE, FITS-ALL...

Lifestyle risks weigh heavier on women's hearts: Study

Lifestyle and health factors that are linked with heart disease appear to have a greater impact on cardiovascular risk in women than men, a study at the American College of Cardiology's Annual Scientific Session has found.

While diet, exercise, smoking, and blood pressure have long been associated with heart disease risk, the new study is the first to indicate that these correlations are higher in women than in males.

According to the researchers, the findings indicate that sex-specific screening or risk assessment methodologies could provide a more realistic picture of cardiovascular risk and better drive people to adopt heart-healthy habits.

"For the same level of health, our study shows that the increase in risk (related to each factor) is higher in women than in men--it's not one-size-fits-all," said Maneesh Sud, MD, PhD, assistant professor in the department of medicine, interventional cardiologist and clinician scientist at Sunnybrook Health Sciences Centre in Toronto and the study's lead author. "This is novel and something that hasn't been seen in other studies."

The Eight Factors

The study focused on eight factors associated with heart disease: diet, sleep, physical activity, smoking, body mass index, blood glucose, lipids and blood pressure.

Overall, the results showed that women were more likely to have fewer negative risk factors and more positive ones compared with men. However, women with more negative risk factors faced a more pronounced increase in their chance of a heart attack, stroke or other cardiovascular event compared to men with a similar risk factor profile.

"We found that women tend to have better health than men, but the impact on outcomes is different," Sud said. "The combination of these factors has a bigger impact in women than it does in men."



The researchers analysed data from over 175,000 Canadian adults who enrolled in the Ontario Health Study between 2009-2017. None of the participants had heart disease at baseline and about 60% were women. Each participant was classified as having ideal or poor health in terms of each of the eight risk factors, and these scores were combined to calculate an overall risk factor profile as poor (fewer than five positive factors or more than three negative factors), intermediate (five to seven positive factors) or ideal (ideal across all eight factors).

Heart Disease Outcomes

During a median follow-up period of just over 11 years, researchers tracked the incidence of seven heart disease outcomes--heart attack, stroke, unstable angina (chest pain that results from restricted blood flow to the heart), peripheral arterial disease (narrowed blood vessels in the arms or legs), heart failure, coronary revascularization (procedures to open blocked arteries) and cardiovascular death--among participants in each of the three groupings.

In the study population, significantly more women were categorized as having ideal health, with 9.1% of women and 4.8% of men scoring a perfect 8 out of 8. Women were also less likely to be categorized as having poor health, with 21.9% of women and 30.5% of men falling into this category. In terms of individual risk factors, women were more likely than men to have ideal diet, blood glucose, cholesterol and blood pressure, while women were slightly less likely than men to have ideal physical activity levels.

After adjusting for age, the results showed that participants of both sexes saw an elevated risk of heart disease if they had poor or intermediate health compared to those with ideal health, but these differences were more extreme in women than men.

Women with poor health had nearly five times the risk of heart disease as women with ideal health, while men with poor health had 2.5 times the risk of heart disease as men with ideal health. Women with intermediate health had 2.3 times the risk as those with ideal health, while men with intermediate health had 1.6 times the risk as those with ideal health.

Common Signs to Watch For

Eat A Heart-Healthy Diet

- Load up on fiber: Eat more whole grains, beans, fruits, and vegetables.
- Choose healthy fats: Use olive oil and eat fish like salmon, which provides omega-3 fats.
- Cut down on salt and sugar: Limit processed foods, salty snacks, and sugary drinks to control blood pressure.
- Follow proven plans: Try the Mediterranean or DASH eating patterns, which focus on fresh produce and lean proteins.

Move Regularly

- Exercise weekly: Aim for at least 150 minutes of moderate activity, like brisk walking or cycling, every week
- Add strength training: Do muscle-strengthening exercises at least two days a week
- Move more daily: Take the stairs, do household chores, or take short five-minute walking breaks if you sit for long periods

Build Healthy Habits

- Quit smoking: Avoid cigarettes and secondhand smoke entirely to protect your blood vessels
- Manage stress: Use deep breathing, meditation, or yoga to lower tension
- Sleep well: Get 7 to 9 hours of quality sleep every night
- Check your numbers: Visit your doctor regularly to monitor your blood pressure, cholesterol, and blood sugar levels

(Courtesy: American Heart Association)

The Quest Continues

Further study is needed to understand how each factor might be affecting outcomes differently in men and women based on either biological or sociocultural factors, the researchers said.

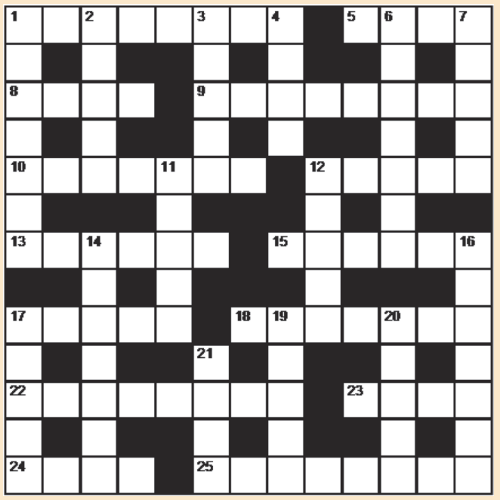
The researchers plan to conduct additional analyses to determine whether there are any differences in risk factor impacts among people of different racial and ethnic groups or among women before and after menopause.

Chai-Time

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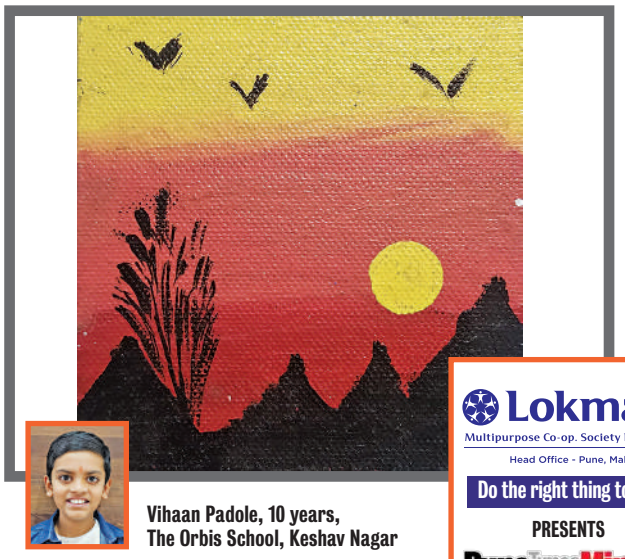


ACROSS
1 Soap or detergent? (8)
5 Cantonment and Koregaon Park area of Pune (4)
8 Take it easy (4)
9 Coming before in position or time (8)
10 Oversight (7)
12 Sums owing (5)
13 Germinate (6)
15 Manufacturers (6)
17 Underworld river (5)
18 Vatican chapel (7)
22 Encouragement to and support of an offence (8)
23 Bath tablet (4)
24 Ballet skirt (4)
25 Member of staff (8)

DOWN
1 Newspaper features (7)
2 New York island? (5)
3 Loose or limp (5)
4 Tracks of wheels in soft earth (4)
6 Friendly or agreeable (7)
7 Tiny openings in the skin (5)
11 The blue of the sky (5)
12 Loved ones, in a manner of speaking? (5)
14 Military retirement (7)
16 Church spire (7)
17 Minimal (5)
19 __ ___ form: like that batsman who goes on scoring hundreds after hundreds? (2,3)
20 Elephant tusk (5)
21 Apportion (4)

FOR ANSWER SCAN ↓

Please send copies of your children's artworks along with a photo of the artist in A4 size.
Do mention their age and the name of the school they attend. You can also mail us unpublished poems by children.



Vihaan Padole, 10 years,
The Orbis School, Keshav Nagar



Aradhya Dattatray Khaire, 10 years,
Priyadarshani School, Moshi

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Pratyush Sushil Kumbhar, 6 years,
Priyadarshani School, Moshi





Atul Shinde, 11 years,
MIT Vishwashanti Gurukul School

WHAT YOUR STARS SAY TODAY

Aries
March 21 - April 20

You'll start seeing positive results from the initiatives you launched three weeks ago. If you spread your energy too thin, it may feel like you're not getting anywhere. What you need is a break from your daily routine.

Taurus
April 21 - May 20

Favorable connections are starting to open up. Look past appearances—you might surprise yourself. You may be feeling a dip in energy, so don't ignore it. Pay closer attention to your sleep, and consider adding some physical activity to your routine.

Gemini
May 21 - June 21

Don't get dragged into pointless, absurd arguments. Skip the useless debates—today, you're especially likely to be pulled in. Lately, your eating habits have thrown your system out of balance, and it's time to reset now.

Cancer
June 22 - July 23

Nothing will dim your great mood today. The sky is smiling at you—and you'll smile right back. Your doubts can't touch who you are, and your outside relationships are supportive too, making everything better—almost effortlessly.

Leo
July 24 – August 23

If you steer clear of a few indulgences and know how to resist temptations that can feel a little unsettling, you'll have plenty to be happy about today—an emotional, opportunity-filled day in every direction. The sky is on your side, bringing you a glow and charisma like no other.

Virgo
August 24 - September 23

The spotlight is on your creativity—it can help you in a big way. Don't keep your ideas in the dark; they hold real power. You'll be more receptive to microbes and bacteria. Conserve your energy and don't overexpose yourself!

Libra
September 24 - October 22

The sky is shining, and it refreshes your perspective. Your imagination is running wild, and the future is starting to take shape in the best possible light. You feel ready to see clearly what could free you from the fears and timidity that have been holding back your growth.

Scorpio
October 23 - November 22

Step away from negative people—you need optimism. Put yourself first more than ever. You'll tune in to your natural needs and learn how to turn them into an advantage. You'll also find a smarter balance between rest and action.

Sagittarius
November 23 - December 22

It's a particularly intense day, and you'll need to manage it as best you can for your own benefit. You're taking on too much at once, and the people around you may make it harder to see the exact path you need to follow to reach your goals.

Capricorn
December 23 - January 20

You don't hesitate to put your imagination to work and break free from your routine. An escape is calling your name. Your vitality draws you into conversations and meaningful exchanges that lift your spirit and recharge you from the inside out.

Aquarius
January 21 - February 19

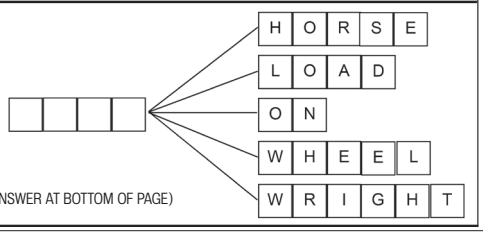
Your stubbornness can steer you into dead ends. Pause before you push your plan forward. Small annoyances can quickly harden into fixed ideas—so look for the nuance.

Pisces
February 20 - March 20

Holding yourself together isn't the same as holding back from life. You can afford to express yourself more—naturally. You're going to learn a lot about someone in your circle. Keep it to yourself.

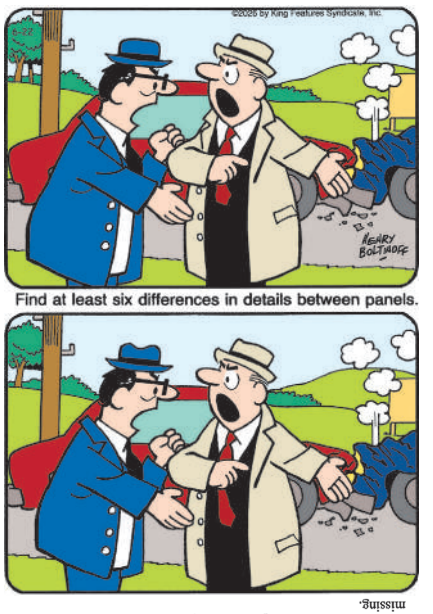
DOUBLE - BARRELLED

What word can be placed in front of the five words shown to form in each case another word ?



(ANSWER AT BOTTOM OF PAGE)

HOCUSFOCUS



Find at least six differences in details between panels.

ANSWER FOR DOUBLE-BARRELLED : Cart

Differences: 1. Hat is different. 2. Pocket is lower. 3. Tie is longer. 4. Jacket is shorter. 5. Lapel is missing. 6. Tree trunk is missing.

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BADSHAH & ISHA RIKHI CALL IT QUITS



Bollywood and the Punjabi entertainment industry woke up to a surprise announcement as rapper-singer Badshah and actor Isha Rikhi confirmed that they have decided to part ways. The couple shared a joint statement on Instagram Stories on Monday night, putting an end to weeks of speculation surrounding their relationship.

In their statement, Badshah and Isha made it clear that the decision was mutual and that they wanted to move ahead on separate paths with respect for each other.

"I and Isha Rikhi have mutually decided to part ways and move forward on our separate paths. This decision has been made with mutual respect," Badshah wrote. The couple also requested fans and the media to respect their privacy and avoid further speculation about their relationship.

The announcement comes just five months after their wedding. The couple reportedly got married in an intimate ceremony in March 2026, with news of the wedding emerging after photographs were shared by Isha's mother, Poonam Rikhi. Badshah and Isha had largely kept their relationship away from the spotlight.

However, rumours about trouble in their relationship had been circulating on social media for several weeks. In July, Isha shared a montage of photographs and videos featuring herself and Badshah, accompanied by the caption, "Every storm is a lesson. Every prayer is hope." The emotional post quickly caught the attention of social media users and sparked questions about whether all was well between the couple.

Neither Badshah nor Isha publicly addressed the speculation at the time. Their latest statement now confirms that the relationship has ended, while also making it clear that they do not want to discuss the reasons behind their decision.

For Badshah, this is his second marriage to end in divorce. He was previously married to Jasmine Masih, with whom he shares a daughter. The couple finalised their divorce in 2020 and have continued to co-parent their child.

Isha Rikhi, meanwhile, is known for her work in Punjabi cinema and made her Hindi film debut with Nawabzaade in 2018. She has appeared in films including Ardaas and Mindo Taseeldarni.

For now, both Badshah and Isha appear to be choosing a quiet exit rather than a public post-mortem of their relationship. Their message is simple: the decision was mutual, the next chapter will be separate, and they would like everyone to respect their space.



Kareena dodges Kriti Sanon outfit question

Kareena Kapoor Khan found herself in an unexpected spot at the trailer launch of her upcoming film Daayra when a question about actresses, outfits and trolling came her way. With the ongoing controversy surrounding Kriti Sanon's Raksha Bandhan advertisement making headlines, Kareena was asked whether she has any personal boundaries regarding the clothes she wears on screen.

However, Bebo appeared hesitant to answer the question. That is when director Meghna Gulzar stepped in and offered her take, saying that an actor's clothes in a film are primarily decided according to the character and the director's vision.



Meghna explained that whether the actor is a man or a woman, the wardrobe should suit the character being portrayed. She also pointed out that it is unfair to direct such a question towards just one actor.

The question came amid the social media controversy surrounding Kriti Sanon's appearance in a jewellery brand's Raksha Bandhan advertisement. Kriti was seen wearing an Indo-Western outfit featuring a bralette-style blouse, cape and draped skirt while celebrating the festival with her brother and tying a rakhi to their pet dog. The campaign received criticism from some quarters over its styling and portrayal of the festival.

Kriti later addressed the backlash herself, questioning why women continue to be told what they should and should not wear. She argued that cultural values should not be judged simply by a woman's neckline or clothing choices.

The controversy grew further after Kangana Ranaut criticised the advertisement, while the jewellery brand eventually withdrew the campaign following the backlash.

Against this backdrop, Kareena's decision not to get drawn into the outfit debate appeared particularly noticeable. Rather than turning the Daayra promotional event into another discussion around fashion policing, the focus soon returned to the film.

Daayra marks Kareena's first collaboration with filmmaker Meghna Gulzar. The film features Kareena opposite Malayalam star Prithviraj Sukumaran, with both actors playing police officers who find themselves on opposite sides of a complicated moral line. Meghna has described Kareena's character, DCP Ajooni Kohli, as fiercely righteous, while Prithviraj's DCP Raman Kumar is portrayed as intense and uncompromising.

For now, Kareena seems happy to let her work do the talking. And Meghna's message was equally clear — when it comes to an actor's screen wardrobe, the character should have the final say, not social-media debates.